

November

10



2011

Extinct rhino

Africa's western black rhinoceros was declared extinct in the wild by the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN). Poaching had wiped out this vulnerable species.

Born this day

1483 Martin Luther, German monk. He stood against the corrupt practices of the Roman Catholic Church and helped kickstart the Protestant Reformation.

1960 Neil Gaiman, British author. He is a prolific writer of popular graphic novels and books, including *Sandman* and *Good Omens*.

1958

Hope Diamond

US diamond merchant Harry Winston donated the Hope Diamond to the Smithsonian Institution in Washington, DC, USA. Discovered in a mine in India in the 17th century, this stone is one of the world's most recognizable jewels.

Also on this day

1903 US inventor Mary Anderson received the patent for her invention – the windscreen wiper.

1969 The children's TV show *Sesame Street* was first shown by the National Educational Television network in the USA.

Telescopic titan

2005

The Southern African Large Telescope (SALT), near Sutherland, South Africa, began operating. The largest telescope in the Southern Hemisphere, it attracts astronomers from around the world because it faces no light pollution in its remote location, at an altitude of more than 1,500 m (5,000 ft) above sea level.

